United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

Intangible Cultural Heritage

International cooperation and assistance

Unit 12 PowerPoint presentation

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

In this session…

- International cooperation in the Convention
  - Rationale
  - Shared heritage
- International assistance
  - ICH Fund
  - Purposes, forms, types, procedures, criteria, timetables

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

International cooperation in the Convention

Preamble of Convention

- ‘universal will and common concern’
- ‘spirit of cooperation and mutual assistance’

Purposes of Convention

- ‘provide for international cooperation and assistance’

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

International cooperation in the Convention

States Parties, when they ratify,

‘recognize that the safeguarding of intangible cultural heritage is of general interest to humanity, and to that end undertake to cooperate at the bilateral, subregional, regional and international levels’
(Article 19.2)

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

What is international cooperation?

Article 19.1: cooperation includes

- Exchange of information and experience
- Joint safeguarding initiatives
- Mechanism of assistance to States Parties for safeguarding

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Why international cooperation?

- Contribute to peace and mutual understanding
- Foster solidarity among countries and communities
- Share experiences, discover new ways of going about safeguarding effectively and efficiently

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Shared intangible cultural heritage and its safeguarding

- ICH is found wherever people live, and accompanies them whenever they move, without regard to borders
- People can recognize a shared humanity by seeing that others share similar ICH
- Cooperation should prevail, not competition

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Shared intangible cultural heritage and its safeguarding

- Examples from your own experience?
- The same heritage, or similar?
- A single community, or several?
- How to cooperate in safeguarding?
- Why does competition arise?

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Shared ICH and multi-national nominations

- ODs encourage multi-national cooperation (ODs 13-15)
- Multi-national nominations are examined as a priority (OD 34)
- Inscriptions can be enlarged or reduced (ODs 16-19)
- Mechanism to share information on nomination plans

CC BY SA

Intangible Cultural Heritage Fund

- All States Parties contribute
- General Assembly adopts plan (budget)
- Committee spends funds according to the plan
- ICH Fund is primarily for international assistance (more than 60%)
- Few States Parties request international assistance

Purposes of international assistance

Article 20:

- Safeguarding of heritage inscribed on the USL
- Preparation of inventories
- National, subregional and regional safeguarding projects
- Any other purposes the Committee may deem necessary

Forms of international assistance

Article 21:

(a) studies of safeguarding

(b) provision of experts

(c) training of staff

(d) standard-setting measures

(e) creation of infrastructures

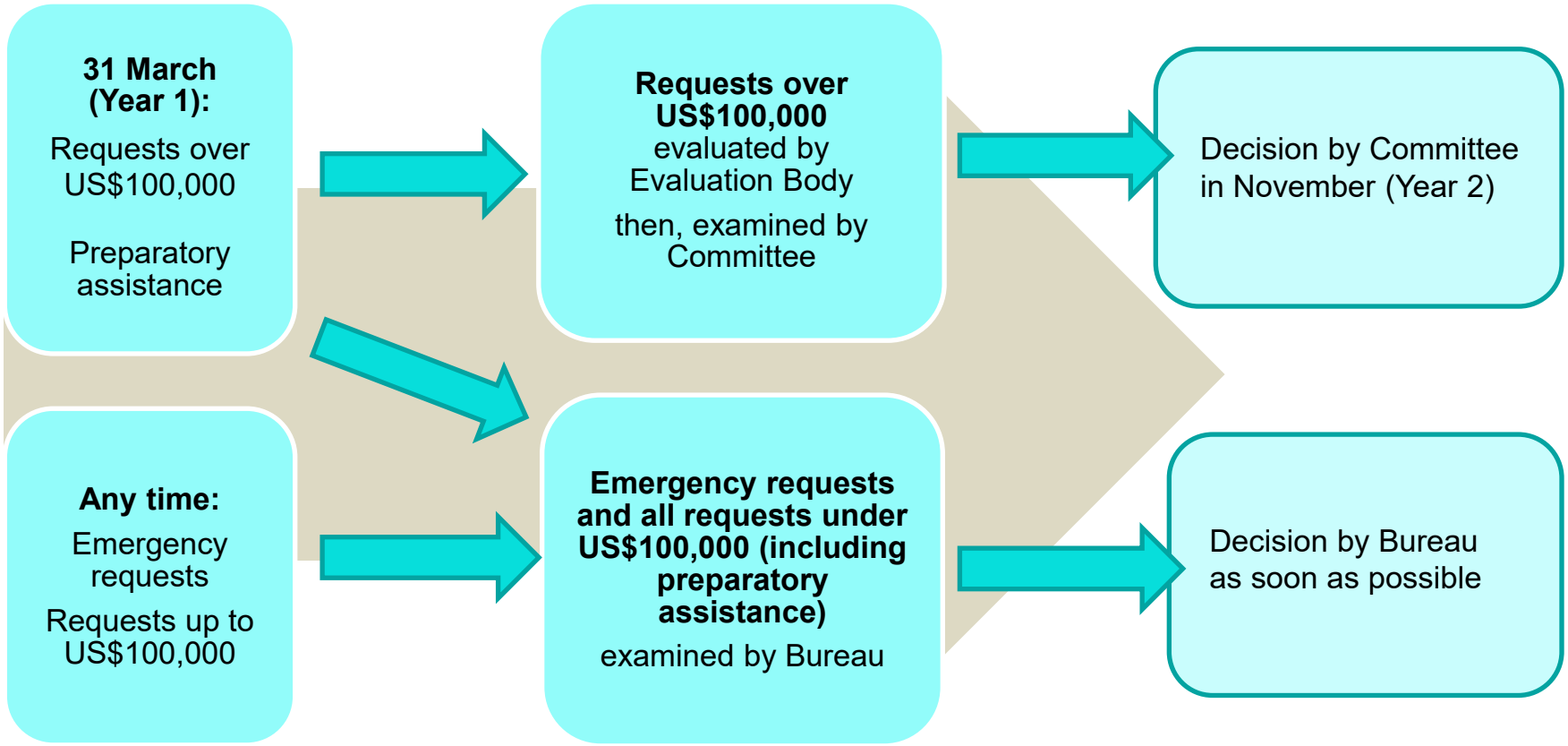
(f) equipment and know-how

(g) financial and technical assistance

Requesting international assistance

Form ICH-04	• Safeguarding projects, in any amount • Emergency assistance, in any amount
Form ICH-01bis	• Nominate to USL and simultaneously request IA for safeguarding
Form ICH-05	USL – preparatory assistance
Form ICH-06	• Register – preparatory assistance

Requesting international assistance: timetable



United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Criteria for granting international assistance

Committee will base its decisions on granting assistance on:

- OD 12 - criteria A.1 through A.7
- OD 10 - additional considerations

Committee may give greater weight to certain criteria or considerations, and less weight to others

CC BY SA

Criteria for granting international assistance

OD 12 - criteria

A.1 Community participation

A.2 Amount is appropriate

A.3 Activities well-conceived & feasible

A.4 Lasting results

A.5 State Party shares costs

A.6 Aims at building up capacity

A.7 Previous assistance implemented according to rules

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Criteria for granting international assistance

OD 10 - additional considerations

- Priority to maintain equitable geographic distribution
- Priority to developing countries
- Does request involve international cooperation?
- Will assistance have a multiplier effect, stimulating other contributions?

CC BY SA

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Preparatory assistance

Special forms and procedures:

- ICH-05 - prepare nomination to USL
- ICH-06 - prepare proposal to Register

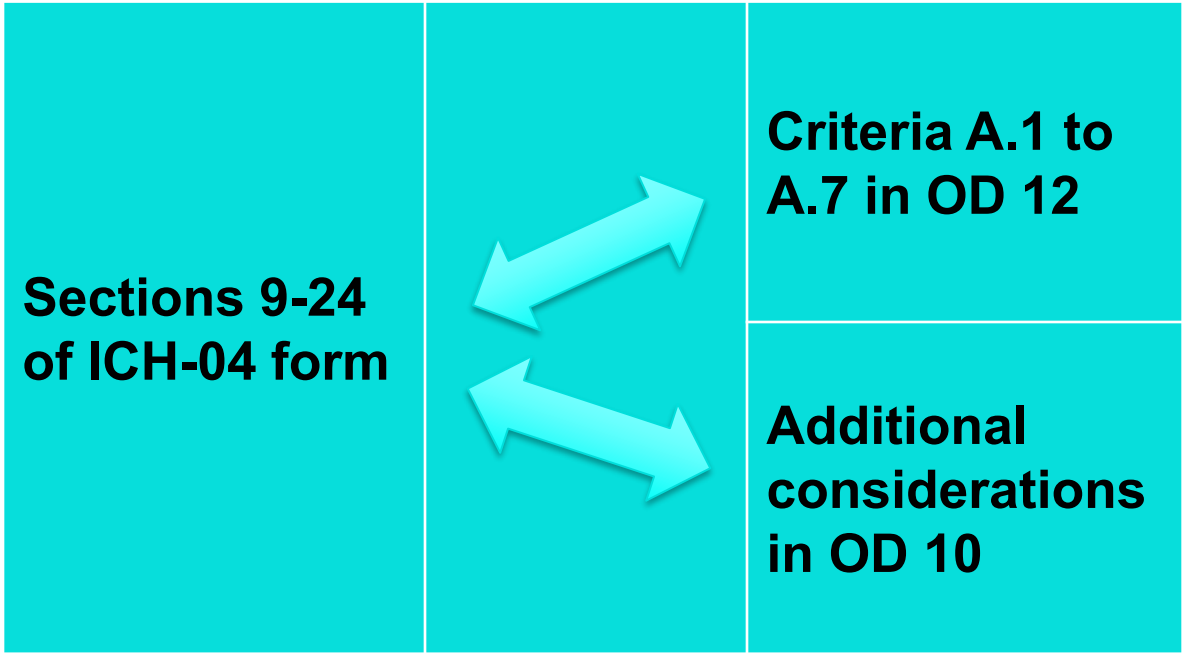
Could be used, for example, for:

- preparation of required audiovisual material (USL)
- provision of expert assistance
- translation services
- organization of community consultations

CC BY SA

Exercise: criteria and the ICH-04 form

- Which section(s) of the ICH-04 form are relevant to which criteria and considerations?



United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Published in 2016 by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, 7, place de Fontenoy, 75352 Paris 07 SP, France

© UNESCO 2016

This publication is available in Open Access under the Attribution-ShareAlike 3.0 IGO (CC-BY-SA 3.0 IGO) license (http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/igo/). By using the content of this publication, the users accept to be bound by the terms of use of the UNESCO Open Access Repository (http://www.unesco.org/open-access/terms-use-ccbysa-en).

The images of this publication do not fall under the CC-BY-SA licence and may not be used, reproduced, or commercialized without the prior permission of the copyright holders.

The designations employed and the presentation of material throughout this publication do not imply the expression of any opinion whatsoever on the part of UNESCO concerning the legal status of any country, territory, city or area or of its authorities, or concerning the delimitation of its frontiers or boundaries.

The ideas and opinions expressed in this publication are those of the authors; they are not necessarily those of UNESCO and do not commit the Organization.